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TAB 21



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-210-25/26, Version: 1
In Control: Board Secretariat Office

Agenda Date: 11/18/2025

Integrated Pest Management Policy Revision Office of the Board Secretariat

Brief Description:

(Integrated Pest Management Policy Revision) Recommends approval of the update to the existing LAUSD Integrated Pest Management Team Policy to allow for a simple majority quorum and the selection of Team member alternates.

Action Proposed:

The Board of Education ("Board") is asked to update the existing LAUSD Integrated Pest Management Team ("Team") Policy to allow for a simple majority quorum and the selection of Team member alternates.

Background:

On March 23, 1999, the District's Board adopted and implemented the LAUSD Integrated Pest Management Policy ("Policy"). The Team serves to provide guidance, verification and recommendations to support the District's goal of Integrated Pest Management for the safest and lowest risk approach to control pest problems while protecting people, property, and the environment.

Since returning from fully remote participation during the COVID-19 global pandemic, the TEAM has experienced challenges meeting quorum. The main basis for this challenge is the original Policy requiring a quorum of 10 members, as opposed to a simple majority quorum. The Team is comprised of 15 Team members, which makes a simple quorum 8 (as opposed to the currently required 10).

Over the course of several meetings, the IPM Team has made clear and requested that the Board amend the Policy to reflect a simple majority quorum.

The IPM Team further would like to instate a process for the approval and maintenance of IPM Team member alternates so that the business of the Team can continue uninterrupted even in the absence of existing regular members. IPM Team alternates will attend all IPM meetings so as to be informed of the material the Team is addressing. Additionally, alternates shall be selected, proposed, and approved in the same manner as existing members: (a) Proposed alternates must fit within the constituencies as defined by existing Policy, (b) must be proposed by the IPM Team itself, (c) must prepare and submit ethics forms and brief bio, and (d) must be approved by the Board. IPM Team alternates shall have the power to vote and shall count towards quorum when acting as alternates for absent regular members.

Expected Outcomes:

The IPM Team will be able to meet quorum more easily, thereby dramatically increasing the likelihood of meetings where discussion and action can legally take place within the framework of the Brown Act.

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Board Options and Consequences:

Failure to approve the individuals as members of the Team will result in organizational and administrative challenges. Quorum will continue to be a real challenge to meet, and the Team will be unable to carry out the duties they are charged with under the IPM Policy.

Policy Implications:

Positive policy implications are anticipated, as the work of the Team will proceed as envisioned and articulated by the Policy.

Budget Impact:

Not applicable.

Student Impact:

Not applicable.

Equity Impact:

Not applicable.

Issues and Analysis:

Not applicable.

Attachments:

A - Amended Original 1999 IPM Policy.

Submitted:

11/07/25

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APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



MICHAEL McLEAN
Executive Officer of the Board of Education

REVIEWED BY:



DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

✓ Approved as to form.

LOS ANGELES UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT INTEGRATED PEST MANAGEMENT POLICY

POLICY STATEMENT

It is the policy of the Los Angeles Unified School District (District) to practice Integrated Pest Management (IPM). All aspects of this program will be in accordance with federal and state laws and regulations, and county ordinances. All District policies must conform to this IPM policy.

Pesticides pose risks to human health and the environment, with special risks to children. It is recognized that pesticides cause adverse health effects in humans such as cancer, neurological disruption, birth defects, genetic alteration, reproductive harm, immune system dysfunction, endocrine disruption and acute poisoning. Pests will be controlled to protect the health and safety of students and staff, maintain a productive learning environment and maintain the integrity of school buildings and grounds. Pesticides will not be used to control pests for aesthetic reasons alone. The safety and health of students, staff and the environment will be paramount.

Further, it is the goal of the District to provide for the safest and lowest risk approach to control pest problems while protecting people, the environment and property. The District's IPM Policy incorporates focusing on long-term prevention and will give non-chemical methods first consideration when selecting appropriate pest control techniques. The District will strive to ultimately eliminate the use of all chemical controls.

The "Precautionary Principle" is the long-term objective of the District. The principle recognizes that:

- a) no pesticide product is free from risk or threat to human health, and
- b) industrial producers should be required to prove that their pesticide products demonstrate an absence of the risks enumerated in paragraph two (2) rather than requiring that the government or the public prove that human health is being harmed.

This policy realizes that full implementation of the Precautionary Principle is not possible at this time and may not be for decades. But the District commits itself to full implementation as soon as verifiable scientific data enabling this becomes available.

DECISION MAKING PROCESS

A Pest Management Team will serve to provide guidance and verification regarding procedures, program implementation, and will recommend resolutions for District policies that conflict with this policy. Decisions will be made by a simple majority of all Pest Management Team members voting at meetings. A quorum* of ~~ten (10)~~ members must be present to convene a meeting. The Pest Management Team will be appointed within forty-five (45) calendar days of adoption of this policy. The first meeting of the Pest Management Team must be attended by all members and convened within thirty (30) calendar days of the Team's appointment. The Pest Management Team will decide the frequency of subsequent meetings.

The administration of this program will be conducted by a District-appointed IPM Coordinator. The IPM Coordinator will be an existing District staff position.

The Pest Management Team will be comprised of fifteen (15) independent members: one District non-management representative from Maintenance and Operations, one District representative from Environmental Health and Safety Branch, one District representative from Food Services, the District IPM Coordinator, one IPM expert, two parents of District-enrolled students, two community members, one public health representative, two environmental representatives, one District teacher, one District principal, and one medical practitioner.

The Board of Education's School Safety and Campus Environment Committee must approve all assignments to this Pest Management Team by a simple majority of all members. Selection of the initial Pest Management Team nominees will be the responsibility of groups whose members have participated in and attended at least two (2) of the Policy Development Committee meetings. Thereafter, nominations will be submitted to the Pest Management Team by the fifteen (15) named constituencies. Nominations to a particular slot must be made by a member of that slot's constituency. Pest Management Team membership will be solicited through the *Spotlight*, recognized parent and teachers organizations, unions, and notification and outreach to other independent community groups. Nominations will be screened by the Pest Management Team, then submitted to the School Safety and Campus Environmental Committee for approval at a public meeting.

Pest Management Team members will be randomly divided into two (2) classes of seven (7) and eight (8), comprised as closely as possible of equal numbers of District staff and non-District staff Pest Management Team member constituencies. The seats of the first class shall be vacated after the expiration of the second year; of the second class, at the expiration of the third year, so that approximately one-half may be chosen every year; and if vacancies happen by resignation of otherwise, the School Safety and Campus Environmental Committee may make appointments to fill the vacated seats consistent with the fifteen (15) constituency groups. With the exception of the first term of the second class, Pest Management Team terms will be two (2) years.

This policy shall allow for the selection of alternates in the event that existing Team members are unavailable. Alternates shall be pre-approved and must meet the same requirements and Board approval as existing Team members. Proposed alternates must correspond to, and fill, temporary vacancy according to the constituencies as defined above.

*a quorum is defined here as a simple majority.

PRODUCT AND USE APPROVAL

Product used at the District must be first approved by the Pest Management Team following a careful review of contents, precautions, and low risk methods. In the interim between adoption of this policy and establishment of the Pest Management Team, pest management product use and approval decisions will be made by the District IPM Coordinator in consultation with the independent IPM expert.

All purchasing of pesticides to be used on District sites or property will require the approval of the IPM Coordinator. Only persons specifically authorized by the IPM Coordinator are permitted to bring or apply pesticides on District sites or property; other site employees and non-employees are not permitted to bring or apply pesticides on District property.

Products will be divided into two classifications:

- 1) Products approved by the Pest Management Team by a simple majority of all members for use at the discretion of the pest control technician within the guidelines of this IPM program. This will be called the "Approved List." The Approved List will adhere to the "Pest Management Methods and Product Selection Guidelines" (see Appendix A).
- 2) Products not on the Approved List whose use requires the written approval of the IPM Coordinator and an independent IPM expert (approved by the Pest Management Team) when reduced risk methods are unsuccessful. Use of products not on the Approved List will be reported to and reviewed by the Pest Management Team on a case-by-case basis.

TRAINING

Training of personnel is critical to the success of an IPM program (see Appendix B). All District personnel and contractors, including facilities personnel, principals, teachers, parents, students, and the public, have roles and responsibilities in carrying out this IPM program. Training documentation will be reported to the Pest Management Team.

METHOD OF IPM CONTROL

The following is the preferred order in which pest management will be implemented:

1. Establish area pest management objectives, e.g., kitchens, playgrounds, classrooms, etc.
2. Establish pest threshold levels.
3. Initiate behavioral modification, including improved sanitation.
4. Utilize pest prevention methods, such as structural modification, and/or employ progressive non-chemical methods and techniques, including pest monitoring and trapping.
5. Employ reduced risk progressive pesticide selection as a last resort.

NOTIFICATION, RECORDKEEPING, AND REPORTING

The District will notify parents, employees and students of all pesticide applications using the following guidelines:

1. The District will provide annual notification to parents or guardians in the "Registration Packet" distributed at the beginning of each school year or upon enrollment. Notification will include:
 - a) the IPM policy statement;
 - b) the Approved List;
 - c) the availability of IPM activity records in the main office of each school;
 - d) a request that parents or guardians notify the school principal if their child's health and/or behavior would be influenced by exposure to pesticide products; and
 - e) a mechanism by which parents or guardians can request notification of all pesticide applications.
2. The Approved List will be conspicuously posted annually in the main office of each site and remain posted throughout the year.
3. Applications of products not on the Approved List will be preceded by a 72-hour notification to parents or guardians, and school staff, except for emergencies as determined by the IPM coordinator and an independent IPM expert (approved by the Pest Management Team). Notification will include:
 - a) the product name and active ingredient;
 - b) the target pest;
 - c) the date of pesticide use;
 - d) the signal word indicating the toxicity category of the pesticide;
 - e) a contact for more information; and
 - f) the availability of further information at the school's main office.
4. Signs shall be conspicuously posted around any area where pesticides not on the Approved List are to be applied in a non-emergency situation at least 72-hours before and for five (5) half-lives after any pesticide application. In the event of an emergency as determined in number three (3) above, posting will go up at the time of the application. Signs shall include the information listed in number three (3) above.

IPM PROCEDURES MANUAL

An IPM procedures manual will be written to implement this policy. This manual will be presented to the Pest Management Team for review and approval within nine (9) months after adoption of this policy.